

Nishie Groe

Software Engineer

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NishieGroe.com
LinkedIn
GitHub

Skills

Next.js

React

TypeScript

JavaScript

Node.js

PostgreSQL / SQLite

Prisma

WebSockets / SSE

Docker

AWS

Turborepo

Contentful

Material UI

Tailwind CSS

Interests

Gaming
Apex Legends and Minecraft

Summary

Software Engineer with 8+ years of experience specializing in modern frontend architecture and full-stack development. Expert in Next.js, React, and TypeScript with proven ability to design and deliver scalable multi-tenant applications. Demonstrated success leading architectural initiatives, establishing development teams, and executing complex migrations with zero downtime. As Director of Technology at Veridian Esports, I designed and built a production tournament platform with real-time ingestion of live game data. Passionate about well-documented, maintainable systems that empower teams and drive business value.

Experience

Veridian Esports — **Jun 2026 - Present**
Director of Technology — Remote
https://veridianesports.org/

- **Designed, built, and operate a production esports platform** used by community leagues to run competitive Apex Legends tournaments; 840+ commits and 200+ merged PRs across ~87k lines of strict TypeScript (Next.js 16, React 19, Prisma 7, Tailwind v4)
- **Built a full tournament operations suite**: multi-stage events with groups, invite-gated registration, roster locks, MMR-based seeding, a real-time timed map draft, and live scoring with ALGS tiebreakers
- **Built a live broadcast console** for casters and observers: one-click camera switching to any player or squad, director shortcuts (kill leader, closest enemy), auto-detected live fights surfaced as recommended POVs, off-camera fight alerts, shared multi-observer consoles, and OBS overlays (ticker, match graphics)
- **Engineered a dual-ladder MMR ranking engine** with time-weighted decay and per-ladder Top 25, integrating Overstat.gg, NeatQueue, and Respawn's official stats API with player identity resolution across Discord, Overstat, and in-game IDs
- **Built a standalone real-time ingest server** for Apex Legends' LiveAPI (Node.js, WebSockets, Protocol Buffers) that auto-detects JSON or protobuf per connection, reduces the event stream into live scoreboards streamed over SSE, and routes observer camera commands back to game clients; backed by a match simulator, session replay tooling, and 180 unit tests
- **Own production infrastructure end to end**: Docker on AWS Lightsail behind Caddy TLS with zero-downtime blue/green deploys, plus GitHub Actions CI (1,500+ Vitest tests, schema-drift guard, CodeQL, dependency audits) and SSH auto-deploy with rollback
- **Shipped platform fundamentals**: Discord OAuth with role-based access, player verification, ban-list enforcement, English/Spanish i18n, SEO (JSON-LD, dynamic OG images), and GA4 with Consent Mode v2

United States Gypsum Corporation — **May 2025 - Present**
Software Developer — Chicago, IL
https://www.usg.com/

- **Led an architectural redesign of 21 legacy estimator tools**, designing domain-driven RESTful APIs with OpenAPI specifications and implementing via a Next.js monorepo
- **Architected a Turborepo monorepo** with 6 shared packages achieving 90%+ code reuse across **multi-tenant architecture** (USG/Knauf) while implementing server-first data fetching, i18next/Crowdin OTA internationalization, MUI design system, and strict TS type safety
- Created technical documentation including **OpenAPI specifications, architectural diagrams, and onboarding guides** to facilitate team knowledge sharing and streamline development processes
- Developed and maintained a **headless CMS–driven frontend**, enabling flexible content delivery and scalable UI development

Homelab
Vaultwarden, Homeassistant, Portainer

TV & Movies
Grey's Anatomy, Dexter, Harry Potter, Breaking Bad

Education

Western Illinois University
Information Systems and Management
2018
Bachelors of Science
https://www.wiu.edu/

References

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USG
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- **Built and onboarded a development team**, establishing agile workflows and ceremonies to support rapid iteration
- **Led development efforts to successfully meet pilot go-live deadlines**, coordinating scope, priorities, and delivery
- **Planned and executed the post-pilot roadmap**, guiding the team toward full website deployment within scheduled timelines
- **Interviewed and evaluated engineering candidates**, contributing to the growth and long-term stability of the development team

John Deere **Jun 2022 - Aug 2024**
Senior Software Engineer Moline, IL
https://www.deere.com/en/

- **Led UI/UX modernization initiatives**, designing and implementing React-based micro-frontends to decompose legacy AngularJS and Java monoliths, significantly improving maintainability and development velocity
- **Architected and delivered multiple micro-frontends (MFEs)**, enabling independent deployment, clearer ownership, and faster feature iteration
- **Designed and implemented CI/CD pipelines using Drone**, automating build, test, and deployment workflows for JavaScript and Java micro-frontend applications
- **Modernized backend integrations** by replacing legacy SOAP APIs with RESTful services, improving performance, scalability, and developer experience
- **Conceptualized and developed a container UI framework** to seamlessly host and orchestrate micro-frontends, enhancing system architecture and user experience consistency
- **Leveraged SaaS platforms and AWS services** to host, deploy, and scale frontend and backend applications reliably
- **Conducted international knowledge transfer and technical enablement**, mentoring remote and onshore teams on React, micro-frontend architecture, and UI/UX best practices
- **Reworked and automated M&A operational processes** using advanced SQL capabilities, improving data accuracy and reducing manual effort

John Deere **Jun 2020 - Jun 2022**
Software Engineer Moline, IL
https://www.deere.com/en/

- **Optimized the software development lifecycle**, improving team productivity and accelerating time-to-market for critical product features
- **Conducted comprehensive application portfolio analysis**, identifying and decommissioning underutilized ColdFusion systems to reduce maintenance overhead
- **Led SSO migration** from SiteMinder to Okta across ColdFusion applications, strengthening security posture and modernizing auth workflows
- Supported **application migrations to AWS**, contributing to improved scalability, reliability, and operational efficiency